Giacomo Rella

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Current position

PhD Student, Department of Economics and Statistics, University of Siena, Italy
Dissertation: Essays on Applied Macroeconomics
Supervisor: Prof. Marco P. Tucci
Expected completion: Spring 2021

Areas of research

Applied Macroeconomics; Monetary Economics; Time Series Econometrics; Local Projections

Education

2017- PhD in Economics, Department of Economics and Statistics, University of Siena, Italy
Joint Doctoral Program, Universities of Siena, Pisa, and Florence
Supervisor: Prof. Marco P. Tucci

2014-2017 MSc in Finance (grade: 110/110 *summa cum laude*), University of Siena, Italy
Thesis: "Real and Financial Interacting Markets in Dynamic Models of the Economy with Heterogeneous Agents"
Supervisors: Prof. Serena Sordi, Prof. Alberto Dalmazzo

2011-2014 BA in Business Economics, University of Bari, Italy

Visiting positions

2020 *Visiting PhD Student*, Economics Department, University of Massachusetts-Boston, US
Supervisor: Prof. Yun K. Kim
Period: February to September 2020

2019-2020 *Visiting PhD Student*, Department of Economics, Gent University, Belgium.
Supervisor: Prof. Gert Peersman
Period: September 2019 to February 2020

Further Education

2019 Postgraduate course: "Bayesian Methods in Economics and Finance"
Italian Econometric Association (SIdE), Bertinoro, Italy

2018 Summer School: "Introduction to Agent-based Modeling and Computing"
University of Oslo, Norway

2017 Summer School: "Dynamic Models in Economics and Finance"
University of Verona and AMASES, Canazei, Italy

Teaching

2018 Teaching Assistant at University of Siena, Econometrics (Master of Science), Prof. Marco P. Tucci
Tasks: grading exams.

2016 Tutoring for inmate students, University of Siena and Penitentiary of San Gimignano
Tasks: promote career advancement, provide support for study plans and exams.

Research

Working papers

[1] The Fed, housing, and household debt over time (Job Market Paper)

Department of Economics and Statistics Working Paper No. 850 (University of Siena)

Work in progress

[1] Macroeconomic effects of household debt: a survey

I survey the post-2007 empirical literature on the macroeconomic effects of household debt. The literature is mapped into three families of models according to the econometric specification and to the geographical focus. A common finding of this literature is that household debt expansions are followed by boom-and-bust cycles in economic activity. This predictive power of household debt is found in cross-country panel data, in cross-sectional data on US states and counties as well as in US aggregate time series.

[2] Real and financial effects of non-financial firm debt (with Leila E. Davis, Joao Paulo A. de Souza and Yun K. Kim)

Using flow of funds data for the non-financial corporate sector and balance of payment data in advanced economies over the 1970-2018 period, we find that new borrowing is strongly associated to a rise in holdings of financial assets while being only weakly associated with an increase in capital expenditure. We find, moreover, that the initial infusion of cash that follows upon the settlement of a borrowing transaction accounts for only a small fraction of the increase in financial assets holdings, with the majority of the increase being accounted for non-cash assets. Finally, we estimate a sizable relationship between new borrowing and foreign direct investment in equity. These findings would explain the limited correlation between non-financial corporate debt expansions and subsequent trajectories of aggregate demand in advanced economies found in the literature.

Non peer-reviewed publications

2018 "Recessione, Domanda e Consumi: una riflessione", with Giovanna Scarchilli (March 2, 2019), *Menabò di Etica ed Economia, n. 99/2019*

Grants

2017-2020 3-year Pegaso Ph.D. scholarship awarded from Regione Toscana, Italy
2014-2017 Fee waiving scholarship for master studies at the University of Siena awarded DSU-Toscana
2019 Travel grant, INET/YSI

Seminar and Conference Presentations

2019 *Conferences*: 2019 PhD Annual Meeting by Universities of Tuscany (Pontignano, Italy); INET/YSI Pre-Conference@STOREP (Siena, Italy); 23rd FMM Conference The Euro at 20 (Berlin, Germany).
Seminars: Internal Seminar of the Department of Economics at Gent University (Gent, Belgium).

2020 *Conferences*: Eastern Economic Association Conference in Boston, MA (U.S.A.); 2020 (Virtual) PhD Annual Meeting by Universities of Tuscany.

Affiliations

SIdE, Italian Econometric Association
STOREP, Italian Association for the History of Economic Thought

Languages & Computer Skills

Italian (mother tongue), English (fluent)

Advanced: MATLAB, STATA, EVIEWS, LaTeX
Intermediate: R, E&F CHAOS

Last updated: February 8, 2021